

eight have only one variant per chapter—good. Another two have two variants per chapter—fair. Note that the very worst of the thirty-seven f³⁵ representatives (1876, apr, XV, Sinai) is almost six times ‘better’ than the very best Alexandrian representative, Codex Aleph. Stop for a moment and think about the implications. **How can any sane person defend the proposition that the Alexandrian text-type represents the best line of transmission?**¹

A representative case

In the opening paragraph I stated that variants can be evaluated. I will now take one of the just two merely ‘fair’ f³⁵ representatives—MS 1892, ap, XIV, Jerusalem—list its variants and evaluate them.

- 1:6 ημων 1892^c || --- 1892 [an accidental omission that was corrected]
- 2:5 του || --- (group 1) 1892 [the case being genitive, the meaning is not touched]
- 4:21 πληροφορηθεις || πληροφορηθεις 1892 [an itacism resulting in a misspelling; they would be pronounced the same way]
- 5:11 νυν || --- 1892 [a careless omission that does not change the basic meaning]
- 5:13 ελλογεται || ελλογειτο 1892 [was the copyist trying to change present to imperfect? The meaning is not changed]
- 9:15 μωση || μουσει 1892 [merely an alternate spelling of the proper name]
- 9:27 ως η || ωσει 1892 [an itacism resulting in a misspelling; they would be pronounced the same way]
- 12:8 1892 supplies ο μεταδιδους εν απλοτητι in the margin (a clear case of homoioarcton, and/or -teleuton)
- 13:11 γαρ || --- 1892 [a careless omission that does not change the basic meaning]
- 14:8 αποθησκομεν || αποθησκωμεν 1725,1876,1892 [an itacism that changes Indicative to Subjunctive, that makes little difference in the context; they would be pronounced the same way; the other two MSS do not belong to group 1, so this is an independent change]
- 14:15 χριστος || 1 δωρεαν 1892 [a gratuitous addition that makes little difference]

¹ If I may borrow a statement from Colwell: “These results show convincingly that any attempt to reconstruct an archetype of the Beta Text-type [Alexandrian] on a quantitative basis is doomed to failure.” “These results show convincingly” something else: those copyists were not encumbered with any special respect or consideration for what they were copying. Obviously, they did not believe that they were copying a sacred text, which makes one wonder why they would expend time and material in so doing. I see one explanation that makes sense: they were deliberately perverting the text, presumably under Satanic or demonic influence. By way of contrast, the care with which most f³⁵ copyists did their work implies a high degree of respect for the text being copied. If God were concerned to preserve His Text, what sort of copyist would He use? What sort of copyist would the Holy Spirit protect and bless? [Since both God and Satan exist, someone who excludes the supernatural from his model is being naïve in the extreme.]